

Team: Arturo Ordaz-Gutiérrez, Lucas Summers, Jesus Avalos

Social Context:

Access to different sports and training varies by gender, class, race, and nationality, influencing who even has the opportunity to compete. Also, the gradual inclusion of women and athletes from formerly excluded groups reflects wider social changes, meaning medal distributions across time often reflect social inclusion rather than just athletic performance. For example, women were not allowed to compete in 1896, and when they entered in 1900, they were limited to a few sports considered socially acceptable. Over time, more opportunities changed participation and therefore affected medal distributions.

Cultural Context:

The Olympics carry strong cultural meaning tied to national identity and pride. Winning a medal signifies international recognition and a significant collective achievement for a country, particularly for smaller or developing nations. Cultural attitudes toward sport, gender roles, and physical competition also influence participation rates. Nations also have preferred sports, often based on having a history of domination in the sport, which shape a certain nation's investment in athletes in particular sports as well as the disinvestment in others.

Historical Context:

The Olympics are not a neutral competition, rather they reflect the social and political conditions of their time. They have been shaped by major global events, including major wars which have caused cancellations, boycotts, and exclusions. For example, World War II caused the games to be canceled, as well as postwar, Germany and Japan were excluded. During periods like the Cold War, medal counts were treated as measures of national strength, adding a new angle of geopolitical tension into the competition.

Institutional Context:

The Olympics are governed globally by the International Olympic Committee (IOC) as well as the various National Olympic Committees (NOC). They determine changing the eligibility rules, inclusion of sports, qualification systems, and standards for judging. Decisions such as adding or removing a sport, changing rules for a competition, or implementing policies like anti-doping all affect who competes and can potentially win a medal.

Material Context:

This dataset contains all archived event results from all Olympic Games, both Winter and Summer, spanning from Athens 1896 to Rio 2016. It includes variables such as athlete demographics (age, sex, height, weight, etc.), country, sport and event, year, host city, and medal outcomes (gold, silver, bronze, or none). The data was scraped and compiled from www.sports-reference.com.